

Mainstream AMD X670E Motherboards

AM5 beckons!

This was the year that AMD finally moved to a new platform. PC enthusiasts are in two minds over the move.

AMD's AM4 platform had allowed folks to simply update the BIOS and upgrade to a new and powerful CPU. That's nearly five years of processors on a single socket. Hopefully, the same will be with AM5. With the X670E platform, AMD added DDR5 support, PCIe Gen 5.0 lanes, and the socket moved from a PGA (Pin Grid Array) to LGA (Land Grid Array). With AMD's new boards, be it on the X670 platform or the B650 platform, the cost is a little prohibitive compared to Intel's 600 series and 700 series boards. Thus, folks wanting to get onto the Ryzen 7000 bandwagon have a little extra to pay. Hopefully soon, we'll get more economical boards. Lastly, AMD came out with EXPO, a standardised timing scheme that allows memory manufacturers to store profiles on the DIMMs the same way that Intel did with XMP. This gives folks a much easier time getting memory sticks to work with new builds. And if you're wondering

which is the best board for your Ryzen 7000 PC, then this year's Zero1 Winner will be a great candidate.

Winner: ASUS ROG CROSSHAIR X670E HERO

Straight off the bat, you get two USB4 ports on the ASUS ROG CROSSHAIR X670E HERO along with a flagship-grade audio CODEC along with an integrated DAC. Unlike the Z790 boards, this flagship only comes with a 2.5 GbE port but there's still Wi-Fi 6E. Aside from that there are two PCIe 5.0 slots and even two PCIe 5.0 M.2 slots. AMD had introduced PCIe 4.0 M.2 slots in the mainstream market and they're doing it again with PCIe 5.0 M.2 slots. Just like last time, there aren't any SSDs that can take advantage of the bandwidth that boards. We're talking speeds that easily hit 12



ASUS ROG CROSSHAIR X670E HERO

Price: ₹65,815



GBps. For folks who like to push their processors to the extreme, there's an 18+2 teamed VRM design along with overclocking features that allow you to leverage the architectural improvements that the new Ryzen 7000 processors ship with.

1st Runner-up: ASUS ROG STRIX X670E-E GAMING WIFI

The STRIX line up is a little tame compared to the CROSSHAIR HERO but not by a huge margin. The board also features an 18+2 VRM design and has a competitive set of connectivity options. There's a lot less of the aluminium shielding but those things don't affect performance anyway. For folks wanting to save a little on their build, this is a pretty decent buy without losing out on most of the features.

Best Buy: MSI MPG X670E CARBON WIFI

Honestly speaking, the MSI MPG X670E CARBON WIFI motherboard and the ASUS ROG STRIX X670E-E GAMING WIFI aren't that apart. ASUS has higher memory speed kits validated and a better audio solution since its CODEC is paired with an AMP. The MSI board is simply a little cheaper and that easily makes it a better buy.

— Mithun Mohandas / mithun@digit.in



ASUS ROG STRIX X670E-E GAMING WIFI
Price: ₹51,049

DIGIT BEST BUY WINNER-2022



MSI MPG X670E CARBON WIFI
Price: ₹48,590